

03. Interview Flow & Panel Roles – Sr. Automation Engineer / Sr. SDET Hiring



Page is about?

This document outlines the structured **interview process**, **panel member roles**, and **evaluation checkpoints** to ensure every candidate is assessed fairly, consistently, and aligned with role expectations.

Purpose

To enable a standardized, transparent, and role-relevant hiring process by:

- Defining stages clearly
- Assigning focused evaluation areas per panelist
- Optimizing time for deep technical assessment
- Documenting outcomes in a structured format

Interview Stages Overview

Stage	Purpose	Owner	Duration
Resume Screening	Shortlist candidate based on tech stack & experience	QA Lead / Engineering Manager	~10 min
Initial Screening (Optional)	Assess soft skills, role interest, notice period	Hiring Manager / Sr. QA	15–20 min
Technical Round – 1	Java, Selenium, Framework, SQL, API, Agile	Sr. SDET / Automation Engineer	60–90 min
Coding + Test Case + SQL Task	Evaluate problem-solving via exercises	Technical Panel	30–45 min
Final Evaluation / Cultural Fit	Team fit, growth potential, long-term alignment	Director / QA Manager	30 min
Decision & Summary Submission	Submit candidate score, recommendation	All Interviewers	Within 24 hrs

Panel Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Panel 1: Java & Framework	Evaluate Java fundamentals, OOPs, exception handling, and automation framework understanding
Panel 2: Selenium + API	Test practical Selenium knowledge, API concepts, RestAssured/Postman
Panel 3: Scenario + Debugging	Present test case design or bug triage scenarios
Panel 4 (Optional): Managerial Fit	Evaluate communication, team fit, expectations, and attitude

Assessment Areas by Round

Technical Round (60–90 min)

Covers Java, Selenium, BDD, API, Framework, SQL

Segment	Focus Area	Time
Java + OOPs	Interface, Inheritance, Collections	15 min
Selenium + Waits	Locators, POM, waits, dynamic UIs	15 min
API Testing	Postman / RestAssured validation	10 min
Automation Framework	POM, utils, reports, structure	10 min

SQL/DB Validation	Write 1–2 queries + explain	10 min
Agile/JIRA/CI-CD Basics	Story ownership, test strategy	10 min
Live Scenarios	Defect ownership, estimation	15 min

Practical Evaluation (30–45 min)

Task Type	Description
Java Coding	Write code (loops, collections, logic) from scratch
Test Case Design	Provide scenario (e.g., login flow, Google search)
SQL Challenge	Join / group by / subquery + data validation logic

Interviewer should review:

- Naming conventions
- Logic clarity
- Modularity / Reusability
- DB understanding

Final Interview / Culture Fit (30 min)

What to Ask	Why It's Important
How do you handle disagreements with devs?	Conflict resolution & attitude
Tell me about your last delivery blocker.	Ownership and problem solving
What motivates you in automation work?	Growth mindset and interest
What areas would you like to upskill in?	Coaching potential and future planning

Time Allocation Summary

Segment	Time
Technical (Java + Tools)	45–60 min
Coding + Scenario Tasks	30–45 min
Final Managerial Round	30 min
Buffer / Q&A	5–10 min